

Juan Carlos Largo

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Professional summary

Juan Carlos Largo is a Senior Frontend Engineer with 4 years of experience: technical lead for frontend in an 11-engineer product organization, and previously the founding engineer who took an international SaaS from idea to production alone. Builds design systems, real-time interfaces, schema-driven forms and data-heavy maps, backed by full-stack ownership in Go and Node.js — designing the APIs consumed, which turns integration into a strength rather than a handoff.

Summary of Qualifications

- **Languages:** TypeScript, JavaScript, Go, HTML5, CSS3, SQL
 - **Frontend:** React, Svelte, Vue, Nuxt, Tailwind CSS, SCSS
 - **Frontend Architecture:** Design systems, component libraries, design tokens, headless and shadcn-based architecture, schema-driven forms, rich-text editors, complex UI state, SSR and SPA, offline-first, accessibility (WCAG), i18n, responsive design, web performance optimization
 - **Real-time & Data:** WebSockets, Server-Sent Events, streaming, polling, data visualization
 - **State Management:** Zustand, TanStack Query, Pinia, Svelte stores and runes, Redux
 - **Testing & Quality:** Vitest, Playwright, unit, integration and end-to-end testing, code review, architectural decision records
 - **Backend:** Go (Gin), Node.js, REST API design, PostgreSQL, Redis, MongoDB, async job queues, event-driven architecture, Stripe, FFmpeg
 - **Practices & Tooling:** Agile/Scrum, npm package publishing, monorepos, Docker, AWS, Cloudflare, GitHub Actions, CI/CD, Grafana, Prometheus, Figma
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Professional experience

Frontend Tech Lead

Unergy | Medellín, Colombia | Feb 2026 – Present

Solar energy company. The enterprise platform runs the business: 20+ modules, 200+ internal users and 100+ investors. Shipped 4 new products alongside it, from a retail energy marketplace to an offline-first field-visit app. Work alongside product, design and QA, after an earlier engagement as Frontend Developer.

- Originated **Gandalf**, a headless design system (tokens, theming, dark mode, live docs) shipped as an internal npm package, now standard across **4 applications** and cutting new-project setup from days to hours.
- Built the real-time layer of an in-house customer-service platform: a WebSocket connector with heartbeat and backoff, plus sequence-guarded fetches reconciling a paginated REST list against a live push stream.
- Built the supplier-payment flow as a branching wizard across 4 payment types, with an index-stable step invariant and a validated 100%-allocation rule, on a platform where forms render from backend schemas.
- Inherited a high-debt codebase and refactored **6 core modules** through code splitting, lazy loading, tree shaking and asset optimization, cutting bundle size and load time **20%**.
- Led a module-by-module Vue-to-Svelte migration on a live platform, backed by dedicated Vitest and Playwright suites that held **zero regressions**, and maintained the company's existing **React** surfaces alongside it.

- Introduced code review standards and architectural decision records where neither existed, mentoring one engineer from junior to mid-level.
- Rebuilt the environmental team's geospatial viewer: a KMZ layer engine computing geometric intersections against open government data while keeping the map interactive.

Senior Software Engineer

Asociación Colombiana de Universidades (ASCUN) | Contract | Dec 2025 – Feb 2026

Sole engineer rebuilding a national gender-based-violence prevention platform for Colombia's association of universities and the Ministry of Education, serving 64+ universities under strict security and compliance requirements for citizen data.

- Rewrote the frontend in **React and TypeScript** across **3 product surfaces** (public portal, authenticated case-management app, internal backoffice), completing the full migration within a two-month engagement.
- Rebuilt a data-heavy **Leaflet** map of Colombia out of a severe rendering bottleneck into a fluid interface, and shipped a conversational assistant that surfaces the correct response protocol for each case.
- Redesigned an unmaintainable legacy **Node.js** backend into a layered architecture with **~70 documented API routes** and predictable, extensible patterns for future contributors.

Founding Engineer

Butter | Remote, US team | Jan 2025 – Jan 2026

US-founded content-generation SaaS, fully remote and English-speaking. Sole technical owner of architecture, delivery and production operations, and technical lead for 3 full-stack engineers as the team grew.

- Built the entire product as founding engineer: a large **Svelte + TypeScript** application over a Go distributed system with async queues, PostgreSQL and Redis on AWS, scaling to **1,500 active users** internationally.
- Built real-time analytics dashboards rendering charts over thousands of data points via WebSockets, polling and streaming, fully responsive across web and mobile from a single codebase.
- Shipped a multi-vendor marketplace end to end, from seller dashboards and checkout to disputes and payouts, on a **Stripe** billing model that kept every payout auditable across vendors.
- Engineered the AI content pipeline (multi-model LLM selection on cost and latency, FFmpeg, GPU scheduling) sustaining **2,000+ jobs/day at ~2.4 min median** with quotas consistent under concurrency.
- Built observability from zero with Grafana and Prometheus: **99.9% uptime** and incident detection **under 5 minutes**, with no DevOps function.

Independent Software Consultant

Kora Studio | Part-time, alongside full-time roles | Jan 2024 – Jan 2026

Independent practice delivering production systems across education, public sector, construction and retail. Every client by referral.

- Architected the core information system of a construction firm in Cartagena, Bogotá and Miami: contracts, service orders, budget trees and a purchase plan tying site activities to supplies.
- Delivered **15+ production systems** as sole architect and engineer, including a school e-commerce platform, a venue-reservation marketplace and a multi-tenant microsite system.
- Built LLM-powered agents across engagements, including a due-diligence agent combining token-cost optimization with human-in-the-loop verification that cut the cost of a run by two orders of magnitude.
- Led delivery with a recurring team of 4 freelance engineers, turning ambiguous requirements into specifications and shipping each engagement with a continuity plan.

Software Engineer

Universidad Nacional de Colombia | Nov 2023 – Dec 2025

Faculty of Engineering. Built and maintained mission-critical internal systems in daily production use, as the only technical person on staff.

- Architected a field-trip platform that cut approval cycles from **1-2 weeks to under 30 minutes** across **200+ trips per semester**, replacing a manual process with automated workflows and budget tracking.
- Engineered a real-time air-quality platform ingesting a distributed sensor network across Medellín, with live dashboards and automated report export meeting the accuracy requirements of published research.
- Led frontend for an internal learning platform with an integrated code-judge engine, handing off **4+ systems** still running independently.

Projects & open source

Pegaso: Course Scheduling Platform | SvelteKit, TypeScript, Go, PostgreSQL | pegaso.implargo.dev

- Multi-constraint schedule builder for Universidad Nacional de Colombia, grown to **6,200+ active users** through entirely organic adoption. The university's later official platform adopted its core design decisions, and the institution explored acquiring it.

air: HTTP Client for TypeScript | npmjs.com/package/@implargo/air

- Published HTTP client on native fetch: zero runtime dependencies, 2.3 kB min+gzip, verified in CI on Node, Bun and Deno, with a documented behavior comparison against ky, ofetch and axios. Runs in production across company and client systems.

Open Source

- **3 merged pull requests** to [shadcn-svelte](#) and [shadcn-vue](#), including a component fix in a library used by thousands of Svelte projects. Migrated the Gin framework's documentation site to Astro.
- Published **gleam-webpush**, the Web Push library for the Gleam ecosystem (RFC 8291 and 8292, zero external dependencies): hexdocs.pm/webpush

Education

B.Sc. Software Engineering | Universidad Nacional de Colombia | 2023 – 2028 *Colombia's highest-ranked public university. Part-time, working full-time since 2023.*

Técnico en Programación de Software | SENA | 2020 – 2021

Languages

Spanish (Native) · English (C1, Professional Working Proficiency · EF SET 78/100 · one year working full-time in English with a US team)